
AMORES PERROS**Alejandro González Iñárritu, 2000**

Sometimes translated as *Love's a Bitch*, the Mexican movie *Amores Perros* paints a disturbing world, especially with its graphic scenes of dog fighting. The movie is set in Mexico City, and consists of three stories of loyalty and disloyalty, each involving a dog and briefly linked by a car accident. Octavio runs off with his brother's wife; Daniel leaves his wife for a model who then loses her leg; and the hitman El Chivo is trying to make contact with the daughter he abandoned at two years old.

IN THE MOOD FOR LOVE**Wong Kar-Wai, 2000**

Chow (Tony Leung) and Su (Maggie Cheung) are neighbors in a Hong Kong apartment block in 1962. Each is convinced that their spouse is having an affair—perhaps with the other's spouse—and they meet to discuss it. They are aware that they may be in love with each other, but resist, unwilling to make the same mistake as their partners. The resignation to their fate is perfectly underpinned by the movie's luminous cinematography and the slow, mesmerizing sound of a repeated Nat King Cole melody.

MULHOLLAND DR.**David Lynch, 2001**

Originally conceived as a TV series, *Mulholland Dr.* leaves the viewer hanging, almost as if it were a trailer for episodes that will never happen. It is full of Lynch's characteristic enigmatic twists

and visual inventiveness. On the face of it, the movie tells the story of aspiring actress Betty Elms (Naomi Watts) who arrives in Los Angeles and makes friends with amnesiac "Rita" (Laura Harring), but it follows many other little stories whose connection is cryptic. Lynch described the movie as "a love story in the city of dreams," and offered no more explanation than that.

See also: *Blue Velvet* 256–57

GOOD BYE, LENIN!**Wolfgang Becker, 2003**

Wolfgang Becker's tender movie tells a story set in East Berlin just before and after the reunification of Germany. In 1989, Alex's mother suffers a nearly fatal heart attack when she witnesses him being arrested while involved in an antigovernment protest. She falls into a coma and doctors warn Alex that any sudden shock—such as the news that the Berlin Wall has just fallen—could kill her. And so, when she awakes, Alex goes through an elaborate and touching charade to keep her believing that life is carrying on as normal in the GDR.

TSOTSI**Gavin Hood, 2005**

Adapted from an Athol Fugard novel, Gavin Hood's *Tsotsi* is the story of David, an inhabitant of a Johannesburg shantytown. As a boy, David finds himself homeless and has to grow up quickly to become Tsotsi, the brutal leader of a violent gang. He is stopped short when he finds a baby in the car of one of his victims. The helplessness of the baby challenges him as he

finds himself obliged to care for it. The movie is driven by the vibrant Kwaito music of Zola, described by one critic as "slowed-down garage music," and a dynamic score by Mark Kilian and Paul Hepker.

CACHÉ**Michael Haneke, 2005**

Michael Haneke's *Caché* (*Hidden*) is a French psychological thriller starring Daniel Auteuil and Juliette Binoche as a well-to-do couple who are sent a series of anonymous surveillance videos showing the exterior of their home. The videos take on a more disturbing significance when they are accompanied by crayon drawings that reveal an intimate knowledge of the man's early years, when his family was considering adopting an Algerian boy. The movie is partly about the repressed memory of *la nuit noire*, the night of October 17, 1961, in Paris, when French police massacred demonstrators against the Algerian War. Haneke skillfully handles the political message while keeping a taut, edge-of-the-seat menace that carries the movie along.

See also: *The White Ribbon* 323

TIMES AND WINDS**Reha Erdem, 2006**

Reha Erdem's *Times and Winds* is a visual poem. It is an affecting look at the lives of three adolescent children in a mountain village in Turkey—two boys, Ömer and Yakup, and a girl Yildiz. Life in this bleak place is harsh, as the villagers try to scratch a living from the soil, but the challenges the three children face in growing up are harder still.